

Microsoft Advertising Partner Workshop

August 18, 2026



 Microsoft Advertising



Partner Program Engagement Timeline

FY27 programs are designed to support acquisition, growth, loyalty, and advocacy throughout the partner lifecycle.



Winning the AI web with Performance Max



Monica Orsino

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Manager, **Microsoft**

 Microsoft Advertising



Today's facilitator



Senior Learning & Development Manager

Monica Orsino

(She, her, hers)

Italian by origin, global by choice. I spent nearly two decades building my career across Ireland and the UK before recently moving back to Rome—still my favorite plot twist.

I've spent 21 years in Digital Marketing, growing with the industry from early search to today's AI-powered transformation.

I'm a regular on industry stages, known for cutting through complexity and turning AI and Advertising into practical, hands-on experiences people can actually use.

Outside of work, I dance Forró—a fast, addictive Brazilian partner dance—because, just like learning, if it doesn't connect, it doesn't last.

By the end of this training, you will be able to:

GET AI-READY WITH PMAX

Confidently explain the benefits of Performance Max (PMax), why it's a must buy and hear some success stories.

PMAX FUNDAMENTALS

Identify and evaluate the critical setup components of PMax, including UET tags, audience signals, product feeds, and measurement solutions, to ensure campaigns are setup properly.

LOOKING AHEAD

Articulate our differentiators between Microsoft Advertising and our competitors, explain what's already available and what's coming soon.

HANDLE COMMON OBJECTIONS

Explain the value of Performance Max and handle most common and popular objections.

The three eras of the web

1

The human web

Shoppers browse and search. People find products by typing queries and clicking through results.

2

The LLM web

Shoppers ask. People turn to AI assistants like Copilot to compare, summarize, and get recommendations.

3

The agentic web

AI acts. Assistants increasingly find, evaluate, and complete purchases on the shopper's behalf.

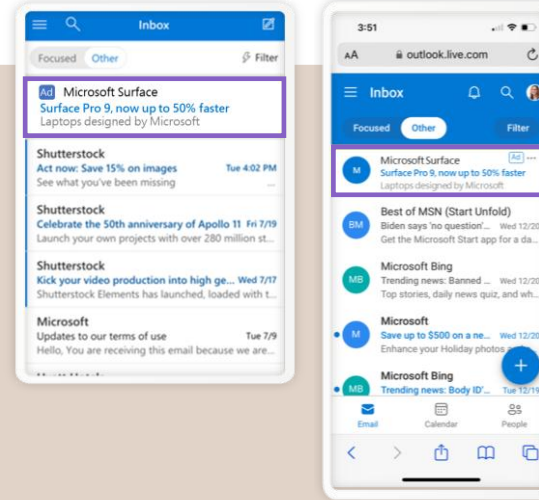
To be discovered, recommended, and chosen, your brand must be easy to access and understand for both humans and AI.

GET AI-READY WITH PERFORMANCE MAX

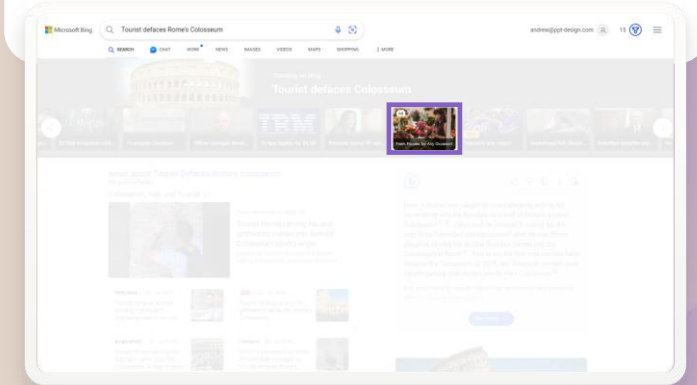
Reach where your customers are spending their time



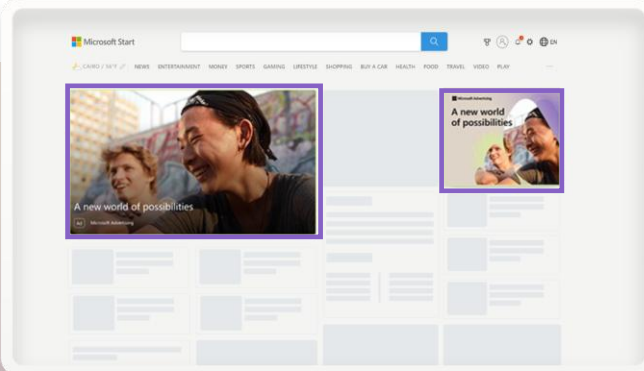
 Outlook: where they connect



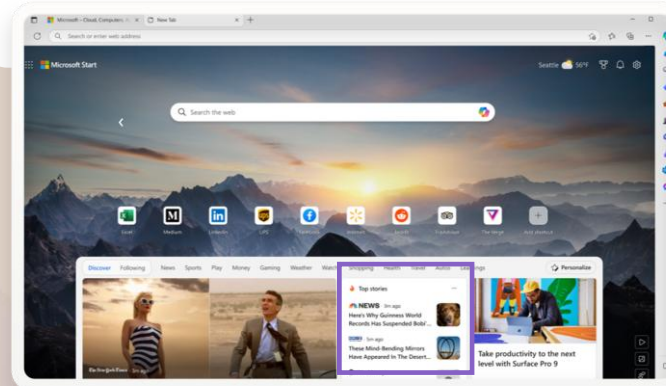
 Bing: where they search



 MSN where they keep up with trusted news and entertainment



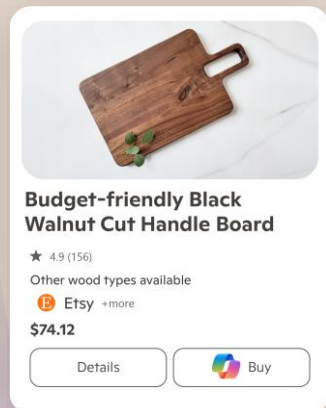
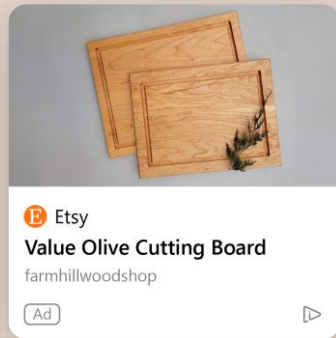
 Microsoft Edge: where they browse and shop online



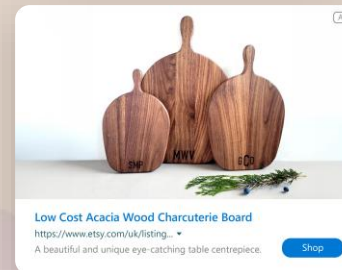
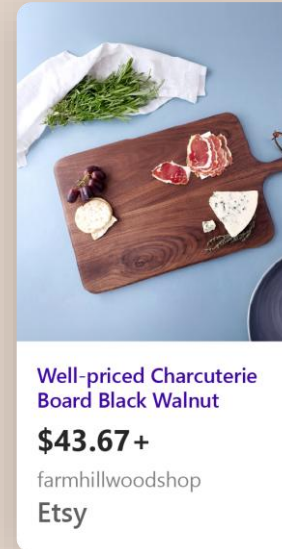
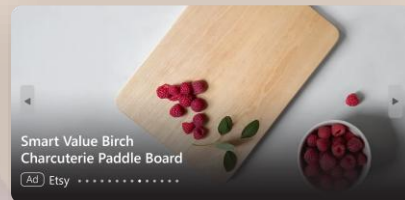
 Microsoft Casual Games: where they play



AI-powered Performance Max helps you drive more conversions across Microsoft properties and formats



Performance Max



+8%

increase in incremental conversions

Performance Max and Copilot

Maximize your chance to appear on Copilot with Pmax: the best of our predictive and generative AI together.

TEXT ADS

What are the top sushi restaurants near me? I'm looking for something authentic

Here are some top sushi restaurants in Austin that offer authentic and delicious experiences:

- 1. Uchi Austin:** Founded by James Beard Award-winning Chef Tyson Cole, Uchi offers non-traditional Japanese cuisine with signature tastings, sushi, and seasonal omakase. It's known for its elevated food and impeccable service.
- 2. Lucky Robot:** This is the first sustainable sushi restaurant in Texas, recognized by the James Beard Foundation's Smart Catch Program. They source their ingredients from local farms and cooperatives, ensuring high environmental and sustainability standards.
- 3. Uchiko Austin:** Originating from the famed Uchi restaurant, Uchiko specializes in upscale sushi, cool tastings, omakase, and small plates in a farmhouse-chic space. It's another creation by Chef Tyson Cole.

These spots should give you a great start on your sushi adventure in Austin! Do any of these sound like what you're looking for?

Microsoft Advertising

If you want to ensure you get a table at your preferred time, you might want to book a table beforehand. Here's a link from Contoso to help you book your place in top Austin sushi restaurants.

Sponsored ...

Book Now on Contoso and Secure Your Spot at Austin's Top Sushi Restaurants.

Reserve with Contoso on Top Sushi Restaurants
Contoso.com



Message Copilot



FEED-BASED ADS

I'm attending a party next April and the dress code is "elegant early 2000s", what do you think I could dress like?

Alright, let's channel that early 2000s chic. Think of timeless icons like Gwyneth Paltrow and Kate Moss. Here's the vibe:

- **Dresses:** Go for a slip dress with delicate straps or a sleek halter-neck dress. Satin or silk fabrics are perfect for that era's elegance.
- **Shoes:** Strappy heels or delicate sandals to keep it classy and stylish.
- **Accessories:** Small shoulder bags, chokers, and minimalistic jewelry to complement the look. Maybe even a touch of glitter on the eyes for that subtle glam.

You're going to nail it. Ready to strut down memory lane?

Microsoft Advertising

Here are some inspiring picks for an early 2000s party look in spring. Depending on what you're looking for you can go for colorful and airy, or maybe you prefer a two-piece suit that's more formal.

Sponsored ...



Satin Kimono Midi Dress
\$119.97 \$164
Contoso.com



Black and White Midi Dress Angel...
\$87
Fabrikam



Halter Tie Neck Midi Dress In Pleat
\$122.99
Contoso.com



Muse Dropped Hem Mini Dress
\$155.97
Contoso.com



Classic Wo...
\$176.50
Fabrikam



Message Copilot



MULTIMEDIA ADS

What vacation rentals would you recommend in Leavenworth?

Leavenworth is such a charming place, like stepping right into Bavaria! Here are a few vacation rentals to consider:

- 1. Icicle Village Resort:** A great spot with a nice balance of comfort and amenities. Perfect for families or couples.
- 2. Sleeping Lady Mountain Resort:** If you're into eco-friendly stays and a more rustic vibe, this place has cozy cabins and beautiful scenery.
- 3. Pine River Ranch:** Offers a more romantic and secluded setting, ideal for couples looking for a quiet getaway.
- 4. Haus Hanika:** Right on the river and only a short walk to downtown. It has that authentic Bavarian feel.

Each of these places has its own charm and appeal, depending on what kind of experience you're after. How does that sound?

Microsoft Advertising

Contoso.com may be worth considering: with its unique rentals, easy booking, and verified reviews, you're sure to find the perfect stay in the charming Bavarian village of Leavenworth. Discover your ideal getaway today.



Sponsored ...

Book your Hotel in Leavenworth WA online with no reservation costs. Benefit from great rates.

Leavenworth Vacation Rentals | Book with Contoso
https://www.contoso.com

Book Now



Message Copilot



GET AI-READY WITH PERFORMANCE MAX

IKEA success story

[link](#)



Modern Comfort Meets AI enabled Strategies: IKEA's AI Story

The goal

Expand reach while simplifying the path to purchase

For decades, IKEA has helped people create comfortable spaces with affordable products, bringing minimalist design into everyday life. As the company grew across the U.S., they spotted some exciting opportunities to boost their online sales and show up more often in search results. But their campaigns and budgets were scattered across different accounts, making it tough to see the big picture and keep track of spending.



The solution

Organize every product category under one digital roof

IKEA and Carat teamed up with Microsoft Advertising to bring their campaigns together and make every ad dollar work harder.

Using [Performance Max](#), they streamlined new customer outreach and returning customer campaigns into one approach, matched gorgeous product photos with targeted [audience signals](#) based on what people are interested in and searching for, and rolled out four more campaigns across their best-selling product lines.

By letting AI simplify complexity and support smarter decision-making, the team could spend more time on strategy and creativity while improving performance.

The results

Stronger returns and elevated interiors

The numbers really tell the story:

Return on ad spend jumped by 140%

Conversion rates went up by 311%

Total conversions climbed by 215%

By combining thoughtful planning with great creative work, the team brought the same simplicity and purpose that make IKEA's products special to their digital marketing.

Our uniqueness | MSA Performance Max

01

Microsoft's **unique network** & ads will serve on **Copilot**

02

Multimedia ads & focus on high intent ads

03

Video assets are not required

04

Unique signals

- LinkedIn profile targeting audience signals
- In-Market Audiences by job title and company size
- Impression-based remarketing
- Search themes hold more weight and don't limit volume (now up to 50)

05

Unique tools: Copilot in MAP, Tone assist tool

06

Campaign limit is 300 instead of just 100

07

Our differentiated approach: rolling out transparency and not making assumptions

- Not forcing video on advertisers
- Within **NCA**, not assuming that "unknown" customers are new
- Learning from advertisers' feedback in the industry

The fundamentals of Performance Max



The fundamentals win with:

1. **Well-structured media mix** with the optimal campaign portfolio and with a comprehensive Pmax structure;
2. **Up-to-date, comprehensive product feeds and inventory**, including an AI-ready product feed and **UCP** in Merchant Center and relevant **assets**.
3. **A well thought audience strategy** with a mix of first and third party data and relevant assets
4. **Accurate tracking and Measurement** in place with Universal Event Tracking (**UET**) and **Merchant Center**, **conversion tracking**, **automated bidding**, and meaningful **conversion values** and **Microsoft Clarity**

01

Media mix & structure

Maximize coverage across Microsoft Advertising

Different campaign types serve different objectives.



Most advertisers benefit from multiple solutions working together.



Define the right campaign mix

Standard Search

EXACT-MATCH CONTROL

Target exact match keywords to hold tight control over your highest-value, high-intent queries.

Audience ads

CREATE AWARENESS & CONSIDERATION

Capture mid-to-upper funnel demand and nurture towards conversion.

Performance Max

MORE CONVERSIONS ACROSS CHANNELS

AI that maximizes performance across Microsoft's full ecosystem.

Customization

AI-powered optimization

Standard Shopping

PRECISION & CONTROL

A catalog catch-all — or product-level control where you need it.

AI Max

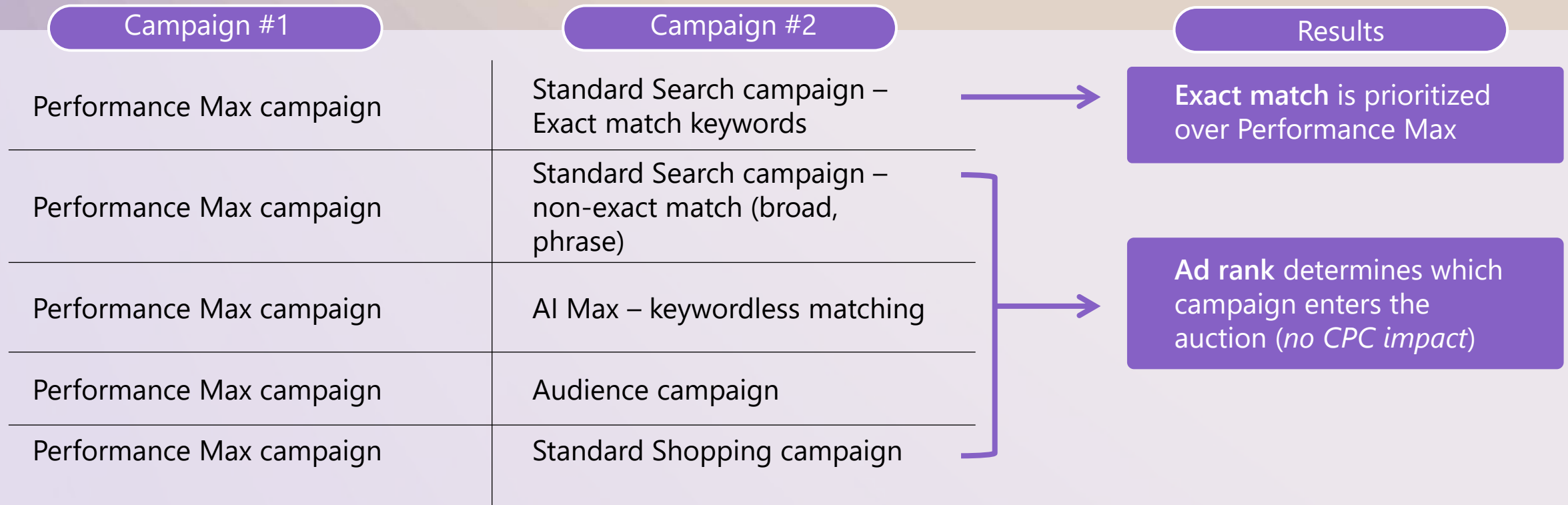
Open pilot

SEARCH THAT SCALES TO NEW INTENT

Lifts Search performance, widens query coverage, and captures high-intent demand.

How different campaigns interact with each other

Ad delivery for Search campaigns using exact match keywords is prioritized over Performance Max and AI Max campaigns. For all other campaign types, the campaign with the highest ad rank will serve.



AI Max or PMax?

01

AI Max

[Open pilot](#)

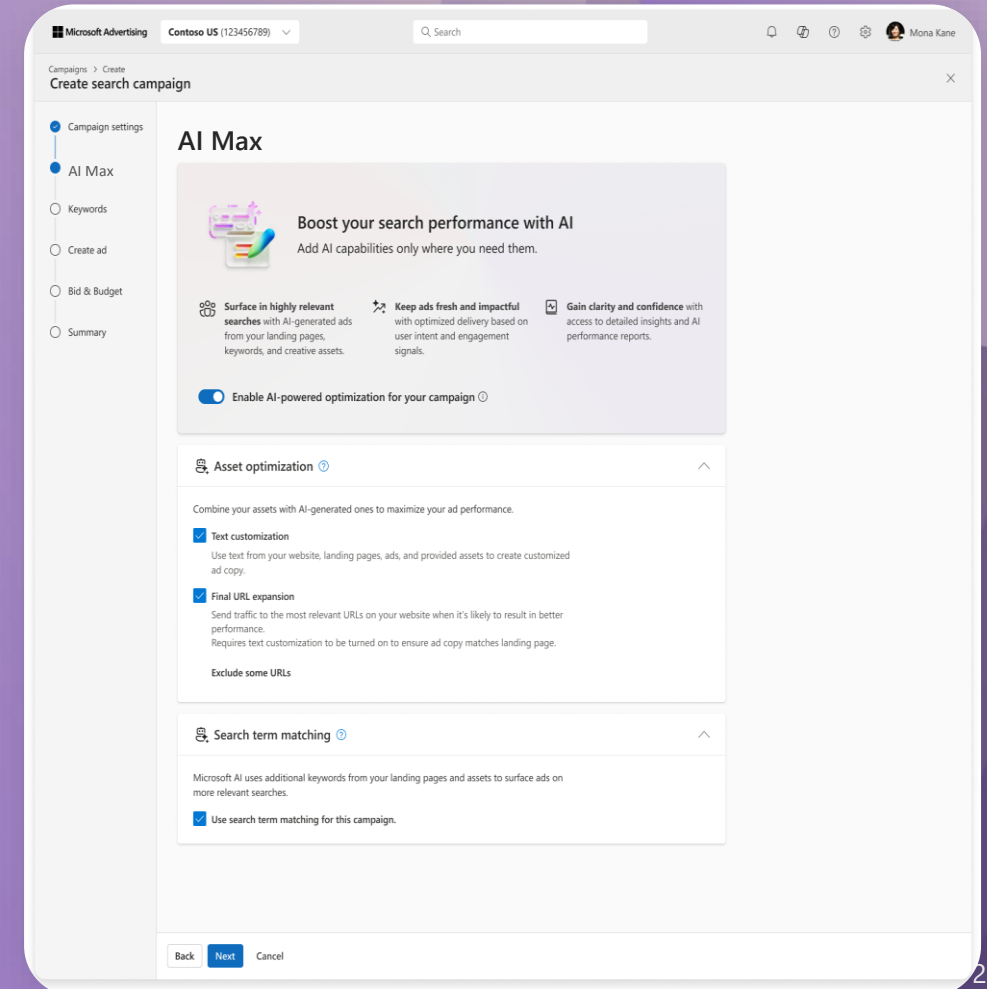
Adds **automation** to standard **Search** and augment Search campaigns: it expands AI matching, personalizes creative, etc. with the control and transparency of Search.

02

Performance Max

A separate **cross-channel** campaign type built to maximize reach and automation **across all of Microsoft's channels**, trading some control for **full automation**.

AI Max enhances Search with a balance of control and automation;
Use PMax for **maximum** reach and **automation** across every channel.



Consolidate campaign structure but separate into different campaigns for:

01

Campaigns for different countries, languages

02

Different budgets or ROAS targets for new or top-selling products, seasonal moments or different shop locations.

03

Seasonal Campaigns: Create new peak-event campaigns to avoid disrupting evergreen campaigns. Launch new assets early on: our system can take up to 1 day to ramp fully and 72-hour ramp for feeds)

Notes for using multiple Performance Max campaigns:

- Max 300 PMax campaigns per account with as many asset groups as needed, organized thematically (bags vs backpacks, etc.)
- Minimum 30 conversions in 30 days.

Lower your ROAS target to boost visibility in the lead-up to peak, while people are still browsing.

Google import callouts



Increased search theme limit: Up to 50



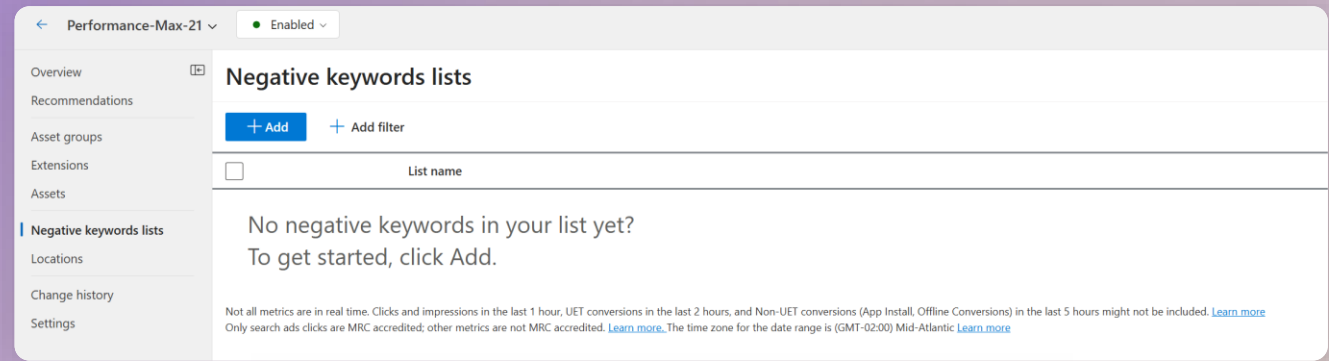
Import negative keyword lists at campaign level.



Bids and budget: Any bids or daily budgets that are lower than 0.05 will be raised to meet the minimums. **Critical to double-check these settings.**



Enhanced asset group import: Stock or images that don't meet our requirements, exceed the 25-image limit, or include auto-generated logos will not be imported. The rest of your asset group will.



✓ Bids and budgets

- ☒ Set unknown ad group bids to the recommended value for Microsoft Advertising ?
- ☐ Customize bids for Microsoft Advertising ?
Increase ▼ by 0 %
- ☒ Update bids ?
- ☒ Update bid strategies ?
- ☒ Increase campaign budgets to the minimum for Microsoft Advertising ?
- ☐ Customize budgets for Microsoft Advertising ?
Increase ▼ by 0 %
- ☒ Update existing campaign budgets ?
- ☒ Increase product group bids to the minimum for Microsoft Advertising ?
- ☒ Do not import negative bid modifier for desktop (except -100%) ?
- ☒ Include portfolio bid strategies ?

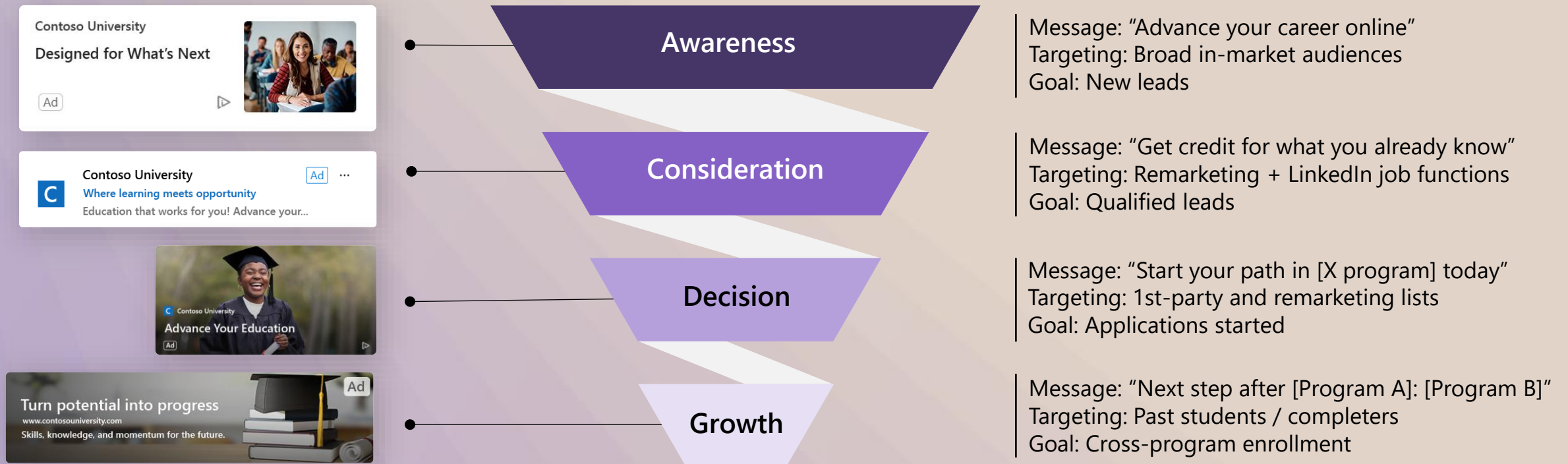
- ☒ Pause newly imported campaigns ?
- ☐ Include paused campaigns when importing new items ?
- ☐ Use ad viewer's time zone for ad scheduling
- ☒ Insert at the end of each campaign name

TO REVIEW

Journey-based asset groups

Move from program-based to journey-based asset groups to personalize each step of the funnel

**Test question: Does journey-based sequencing lower cost per start vs. program-based PMax?*

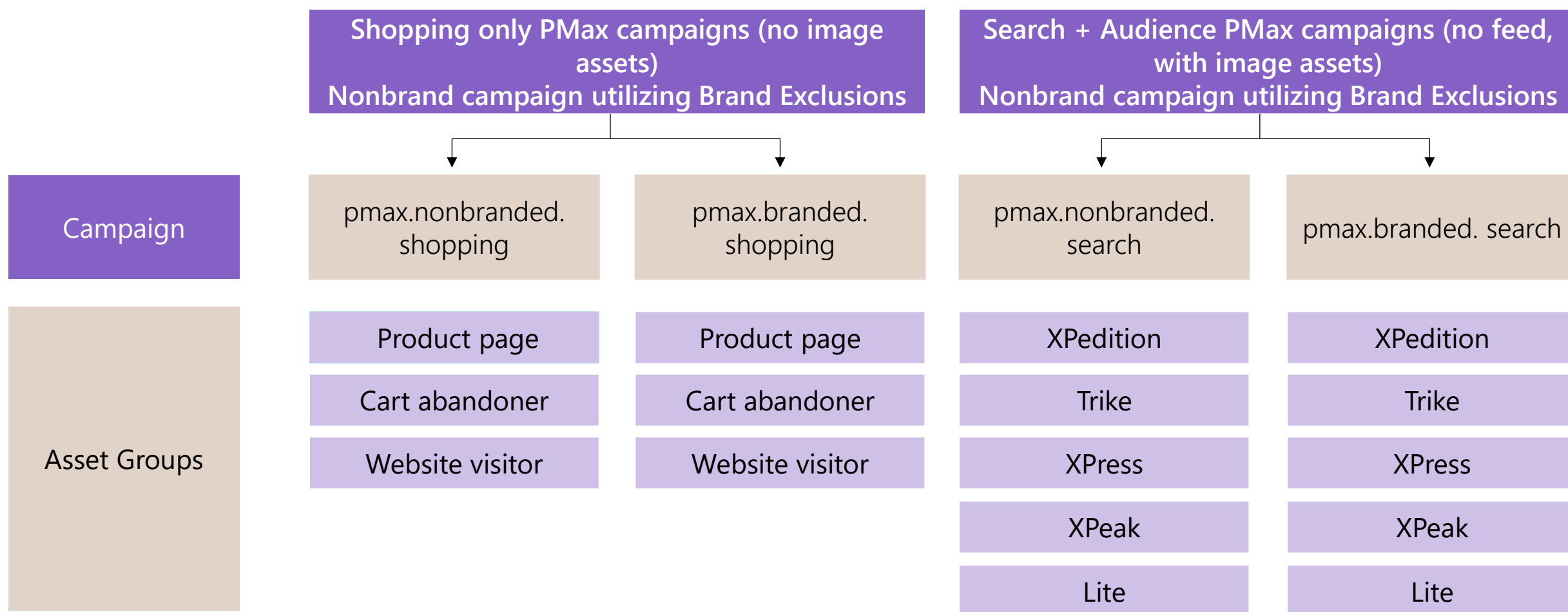


Retail client campaign structure example

Structure by shopping network vs Search + Audience and then by brand and non-brand.

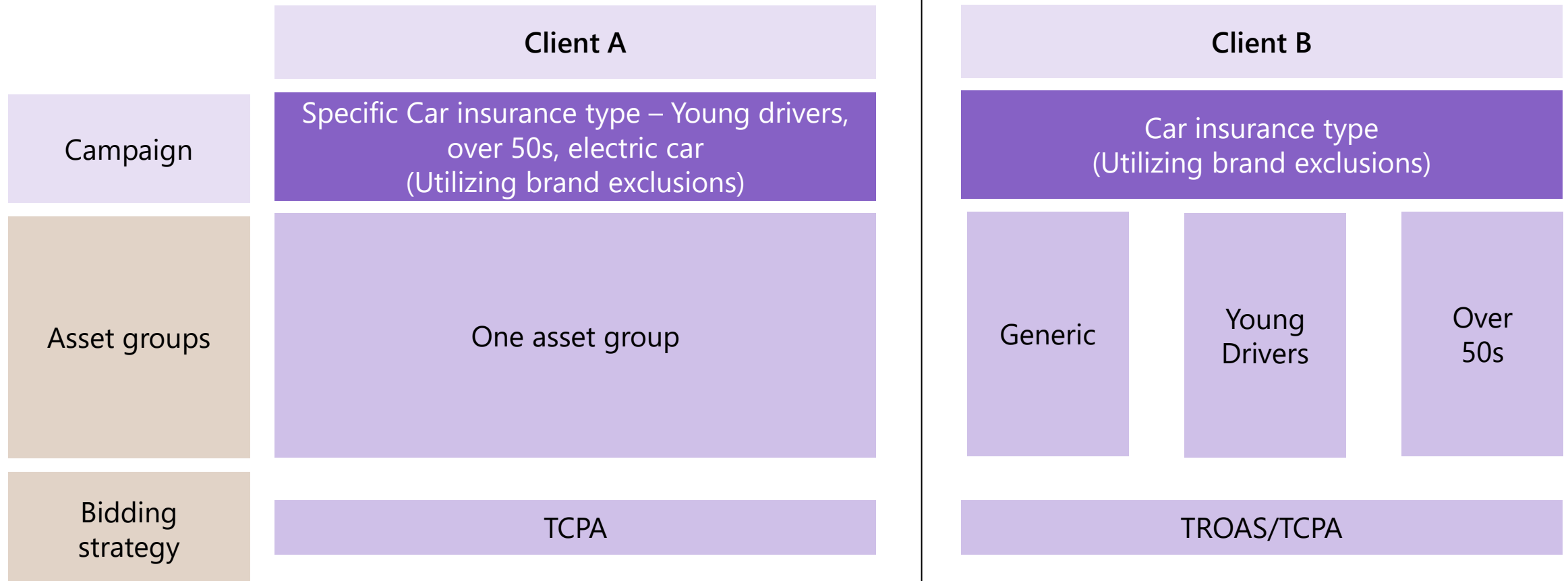
Shopping campaigns further broken by audiences. Search + Audience are broken by product type at asset group level

At least 30 conversions in 30 days.

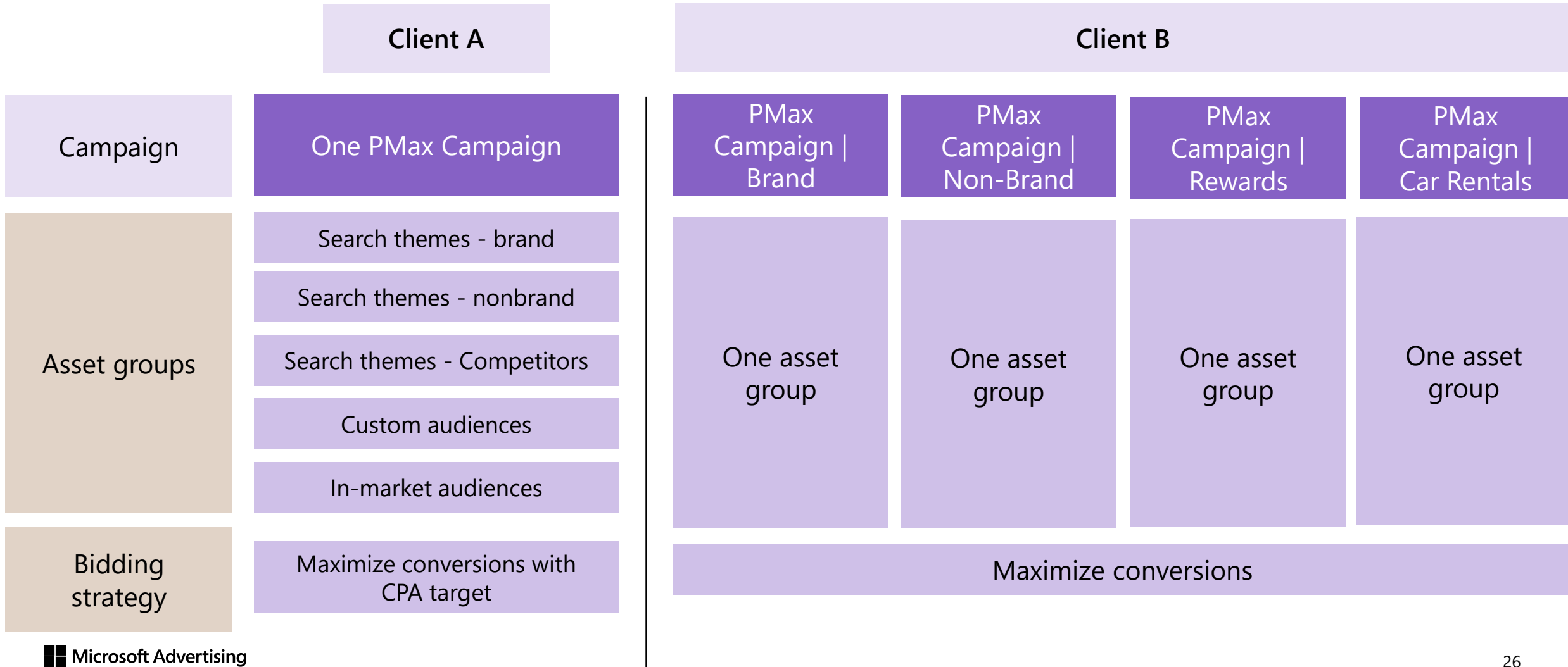


Finance | Contoso price comparison website Pmax structure

Price Comparison website breaks out their campaigns by specific product type and then a catch-all. Both utilizing brand exclusions. ***They have a separate brand account.***



Contoso Airlines campaign structure



Contoso Auto campaign structure examples

Client A

Original Equipment Manufacturer (OEM)

Campaign

One PMax Campaign

Asset groups

Search themes – model 108

Search themes - model 781

Search themes – model 198

Audience
signals

In-Market audience – replacement auto
parts

In-Market audience – motor vehicles by
brand

Bidding
strategy

Maximize conversions with CPA
target

Client B

Car seller and auto part business with various brands and models

Campaign

One PMax Campaign

Asset groups

Search themes – sell my car

Search themes - part exchange

Search themes – trade my car

Audience
signals

In-Market audience – Auto Parts & Accessories

In-Market audience – Auto Interior Parts &
Accessories

Bidding
strategy

Maximize conversions with CPA target

AI readiness matters

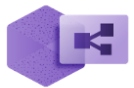
JD Sports enters its next growth phase with an AI-ready strategy after **clicks jump 747%**



The results



747%
Click
growth



99%
Brand
core CVR



85%
Top
impression
share

Summary

- **The goal:** Prepare for AI-driven discovery during peak season
- **The solution:** Align campaigns with key business priorities
- **The strategy:** PMAX to capture cross-channel demand, Broad Match to expand relevant queries, and Auto-Bidding to react in real-time
- **The results:** Record revenue when demand was highest

“We know that our customers are increasingly using AI-enabled experiences for inspiration. We want to show up for our customers where they are, so we launched a new AI-led structure ahead of peak. This gave the platform a fuller view of intent, turning inspiration moments into buying decisions.”

Liza Nolan

Associate Director of Digital Media
JD Sports

02

Feeds, Merchant Centre

Top driver: Optimize product title

"I don't show for 'small gift for a coworker'"



Travel sized lavender hand cream

Product title:

Make your Product Titles as robust a possible.
Include brand details, key search terms, and product attributes:

Brand + Product Name + Product Type + Gender + Size + Color (if applicable)

Test the order of product attributes in your title to understand which will drive most relevant traffic.

Don't:

Put seasonal marketing messages in the product title.*

*unless the itself is specifically a gift item. I.e. Thanksgiving *gift* productt *basket*, Christmas *ornament*, etc.

Product description should match with landing page product details and features.



Top driver: Optimize product description

"I don't show for 'small gift for a coworker'"



Travel sized lavender hand cream

Product description:

- Ensure descriptions are relevant, descriptive, and include special callouts around holidays.
- Include Microsoft Advertising key terms for both title and description to help with product understanding and matching.
- Add Holiday context by highlighting seasonal uses cases:

- Holiday entertaining, gifts for ___, or occasions (family gatherings).

Don't:

Insert keywords into every product description:

- "Great Christmas Gift" or "Best Black Friday Sale"

Forget to adjust product descriptions post-holiday season.

Run Search Term Reports to see which queries are triggering Product ads



Top driver: Optimize product titles & descriptions

"I don't show for 'small gift for a coworker'"



Good:

Travel sized lavender **hand cream**

Enriched with **shea butter** and **lavender essential oil**, this smooth, **light-textured cream** gently helps to nourish the hands leaving them softly perfumed.

Better for holidays:

2.6 oz lavender shea butter **hand cream**

Enriched with **shea butter** and **lavender essential oil**, this **lightweight hand cream** helps nourish hands and leave them softly perfumed. At **2.6 oz**, it's ideal as a **small gift for a coworker**, and it provides the nourishment needed during the **wintertime**.

AI readiness in Merchant Center



Make your products discoverable.



Provide your entire catalog

Do this:

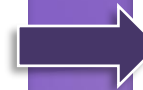
Upload 100% of your catalog so your product can be discoverable in Copilot shopping and organic experiences.



Set up UCP in Merchant Center (Universal Commerce Protocol)

Do this:

1. In Merchant Center > UCP settings: Input your return policy and customer support contact info.
2. Update your feed to be AI-ready and support UCP.



Update your product feed to be AI-ready and support UCP

Do this:

native_commerce (*Copilot checkout*)
merchant_item_id (*unique ID tracks item across feeds and systems*)
consumer_notice_type and **consumer_notice_message** (*consumer warning*)
Add if regulatory compliance requirements apply

UCP is an industry standard language that lets AI assistants, platforms, and online stores work together for online shopping.

Making a list, checking it twice: Product feed audit checklist



THE BASICS

Ensure the foundation is in place.

- ☐ Upload your entire product catalog for AI readiness so products are discoverable in Copilot shopping.
- ☐ Required fields are complete
- ☐ No duplicate titles
Differentiate titles for variant offerings with the color, size, materials, etc.
- ☐ GTIN/MPN is valid
- ☐ Pricing is correct and up to date
- ☐ Product page URLs correct and work
- ☐ All products are included in feed
- ☐ Image URL should be accessible and have a good image of your product
Use custom labels to tag holiday hero products, best sellers, and strategic inventory



THE OPPORTUNITIES

More details in feeds is better.

- ☐ Strong product titles
Create robust titles with product details.
- ☐ Long product descriptions
Confirm accuracy and that they match landing page descriptions.
- ☐ Recommended fields
Provide more metadata to help ads match to more relevant searches.
- ☐ Product categorization
Clarify what your product is.
- ☐ Routine updates to feed
Automate price and status updates.
- ☐ Confirm feed parity with Google
Get the same products. Import can help.
- ☐ UCP attributes
Add return policy, customer support

03

Signals, Audience and Assets Strategy

Search themes keys to success

Add search themes based on top queries.
Refreshing and adding new search themes for PMax will act as an additional signal and won't limit volume.

Product/Category

ORD Airport ✕ Flights to ORD ✕ Car rentals in Chicago ✕
o'hare car rentals ✕ chicago airport car rentals ✕
full sized car rental ORD ✕ Chicago O'Hare International Airport ✕

Seasonal

Travel Tuesday ✕ Black Friday Car Rental Discounts ✕
Travel Deals ✕ (Brand Promotion Name) ✕

Competitive

Enterprise Rent-A-Car ✕ Hertz ✕ Avis ✕
Budget Car Rentals ✕ Thrifty Car Rentals ✕
Expedia Car Rentals ✕ Payless Car Rentals ✕
National Car Rentals ✕ Alamo Car Rentals ✕
Dollar Car Rentals ✕ Sixt Car Rentals ✕
Priceline Car Rentals ✕ Kayak Car Rentals ✕

The screenshot shows the Google Ads interface. On the left is a sidebar with navigation links: Ads Studio, Import, Reporting, Merchant Center, Billing, and Settings. The main content area has a top navigation bar with 'Recent', 'Performance', 'Competitive Insights', and 'Goals and Conversions'. Below this, the 'Recently used templates' section is visible, with 'Search terms insights' highlighted by a green box. The 'Search terms insights' card includes a 'Performance' tab and a description: 'Gain valuable insights into how your customers search for your business. These insights analyze the specific search term...'. To the right of this card is another card titled 'Search term' with a description: 'Get insight into what your audience is searching for when your ads are shown, so that you can make informed addition...'. The 'Reporting' section is also visible on the right side of the interface.

The screenshot shows the 'Search terms insights' reporting page. It has a top navigation bar with 'Reporting' and 'Search terms insights'. Below this is a 'Modify' section with a close button (✕). The 'Breakdown' section is expanded, showing three categories: 'Search Category', 'Search Volume', and 'Search term', each with a dropdown arrow (v). The 'Search term' category is currently selected.

Develop Audience strategies early



- Leverage your First Party Data for Audiences!
- Build Audience lists early to ensure sufficient scale before peak.
- Separate prospecting and retargeting into distinct campaigns with tailored bids and messaging.
- In-Market and Similar Audiences are great for acquisition and prospecting.
- Build Remarketing, Dynamic Remarketing, and Customer Match for re-engagement and personalized offers during peak
- Impression-Based Remarketing creates audience lists from ad exposure.
- Activate seasonal audiences such as Black Friday and Christmas segments.

LinkedIn profile targeting

Add as a signal audiences based on their LinkedIn professional profile.



Company

Example: Microsoft, Verizon, Adobe, etc.



Job function

Example: engineering, sales, consulting, etc.



Industry

Example: retail, banking, marketing, etc.



Job seniority

Example: entry, senior, manager, director, VP, etc.

**New-
Closed Pilot**

Company ?

Note: the target option will be bid only, and won't narrow your audience.

[Edit target](#)

	Companies
☒ Targeted	 Microsoft Computer Software; > 10,000 employees
Show rows:	20 v

Industry ?

Note: the target option will be bid only, and won't narrow your audience.

[Edit target](#)

	Industries
☒ Targeted	Computer Software
Show rows:	20 v

Job function ?

Note: the target option will be bid only, and won't narrow your audience.

[Edit target](#)

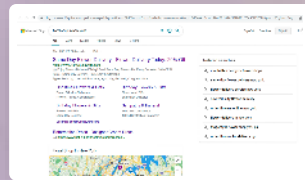
	Job functions
☒ Targeted	Information Technology

Impression-based remarketing is a unique signal

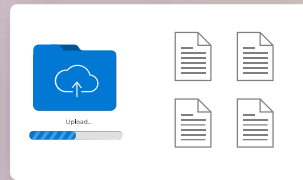
Engage with people who've seen your ads, even if they haven't clicked, with sequential messaging that guides them from initial interest to conversion.



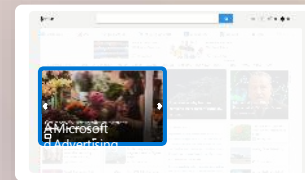
Olivia is in-market for a birthday gift...



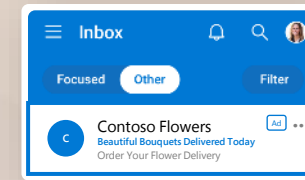
Olivia is searching on Bing for a gift. She sees your ad, but clicks on a competitor.



Olivia is placed in your impression-based remarketing list.



The next day, she visits MSN and sees your ad, keeping your brand top of mind.



Later, while checking emails, she sees your ad, clicks, and visits your site.



Olivia chooses to buy flowers from your company and checks out on your site.

Make your assets seasonally relevant

- **Refresh creative** to match user's intent:
 - ❖ Retarget with relevant products and offers to drive consideration.
 - ❖ Drive urgency with promotions, shipping deadlines, or limited offers closer to purchase.
 - ❖ Introduce gift ideas and inspiration-focused creative to build awareness.
- Provide multiple aspect ratios and creative variations. Use the **Ad Preview tool**
- Leverage **Ads Studio** to build AI-generated seasonal assets and Assets reporting for optimization.
- Lead with holiday or gifting-oriented messaging. **Highlight promotions**, special product bundles, and other differentiators.

CHRISTMAS ATMOSPHERE



HALLOWEEN SCENE



LUNAR NEW YEAR

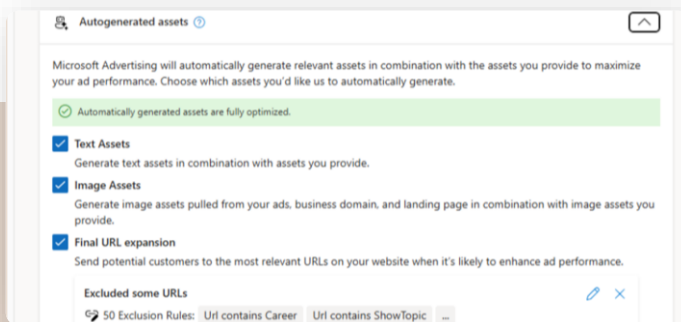


VALENTINE'S DAY SCENE



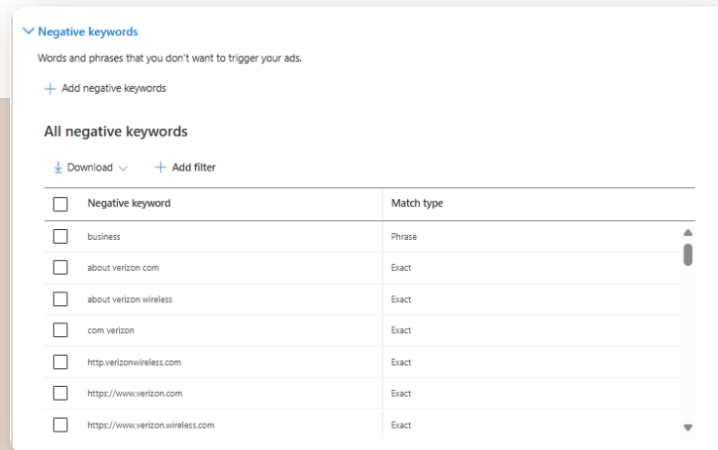
Controls for your creative assets and your brand

1 Autogenerated asset settings



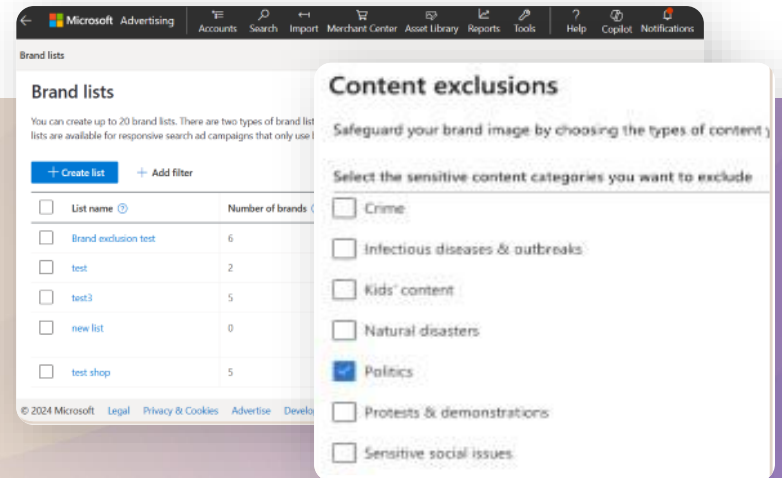
Options include text assets, image assets and final URL expansion.

2 Negative keywords and website exclusions



Account level website exclusion lists and **campaign level negative keywords**.

3 Brand exclusions and brand suitability controls



Brand lists for query funneling and content exclusions to safeguard brand.

04

Tracking and Measurement

UET tag is the basis of Automation: Key steps for success

1

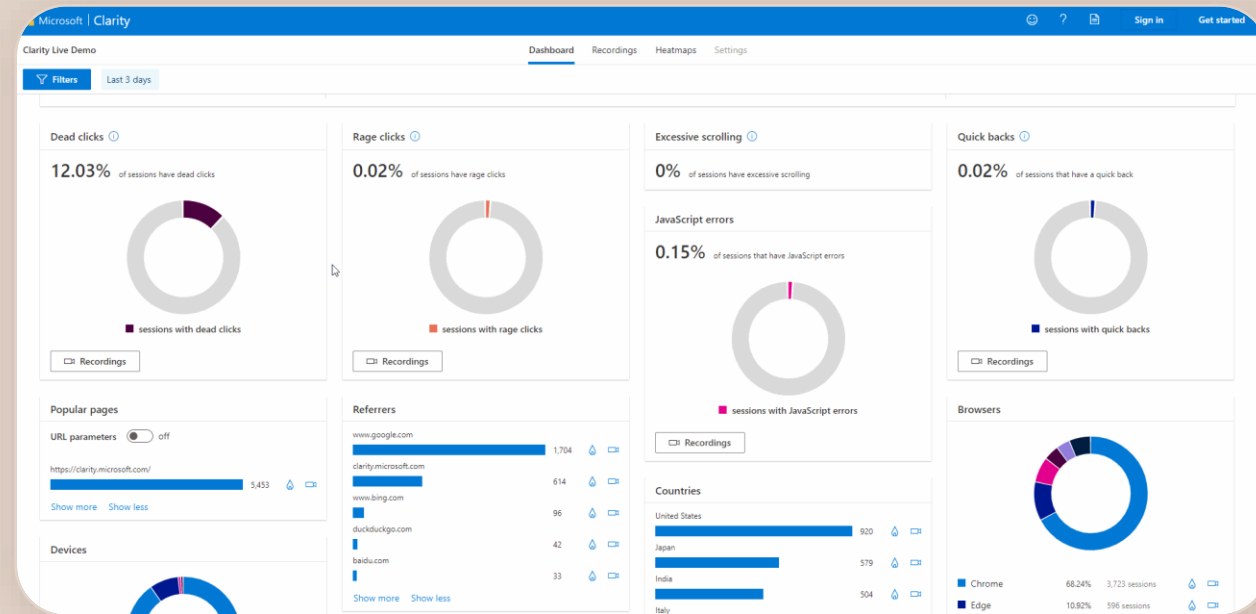
Universal Event Tracking: 1 tag to rule them all!
Implement it on every page directly or through
Tag managers

2

Update your UET tag with **Consent Mode** and all
recommended parameters, i.e. page type and product
ID for Dynamic Remarketing, dynamic revenue or
custom events, etc. Create conversions goals

3

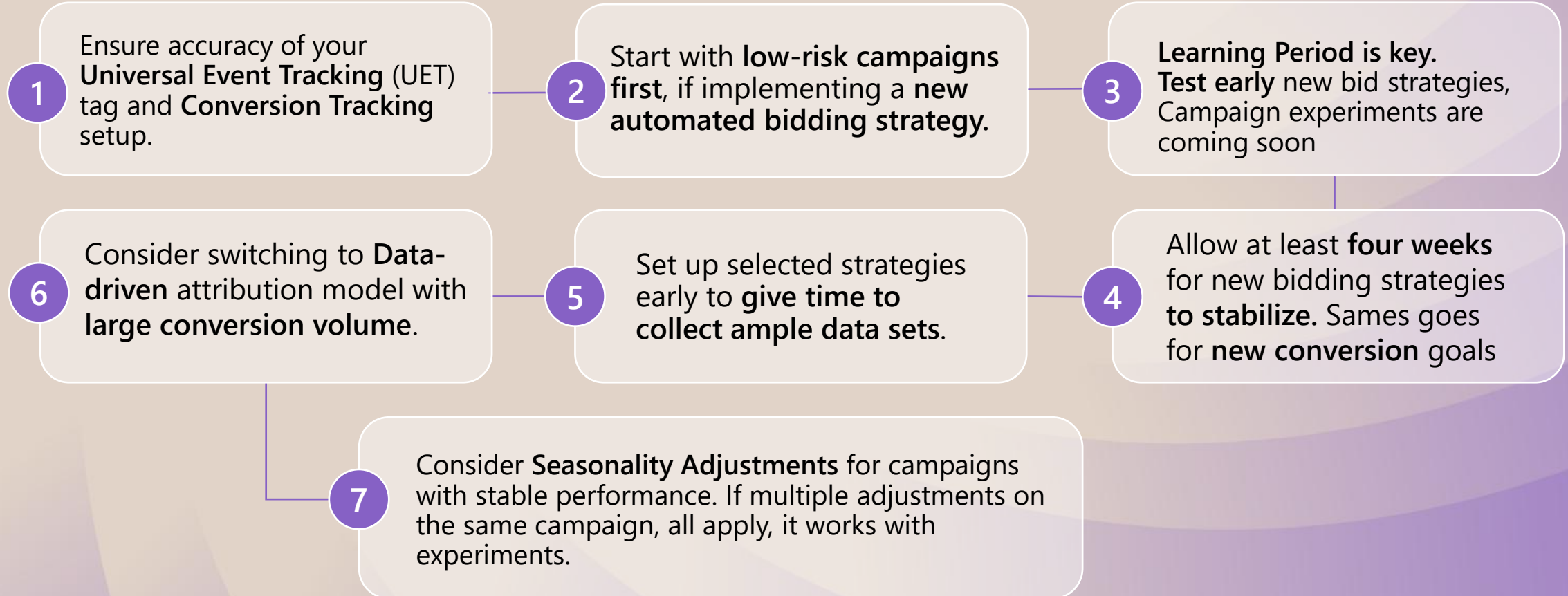
Leverage troubleshooting tools (UET Dashboard,
Insights, UET Tag Helper), and Clarity to ensure
everything works as it should.



Drive strong ad performance with UET

	What Microsoft Advertising UET provides for Microsoft Advertising  Microsoft Advertising	 Search Ads 360 What Google Floodlight via SA360 provides for Microsoft Advertising
Conversion Tracking	Track conversion data related to Microsoft Advertising with all your Microsoft Advertising accounts	Share conversion data attributed to Microsoft Advertising with all Microsoft Advertising accounts linked to your SA360 sub-manager account
Audience Building	Real-time data for building your audiences → improved performance	No data for building your audiences → poorer performance
Ad Personalization	Personalized ad experiences based on site interactions that help improve performance, including: - Remarketing - Dynamic remarketing	No personalized ad experiences based on site interactions → poorer performance
Comprehensive Attribution	All Microsoft touchpoints available in attribution modeling and conversion reporting (including impressions, video views, etc.)*	Limited touchpoints available in attribution modeling and reporting - only click-based traffic
Product Support	Support for all Microsoft Advertising products, including Performance Max and Audience ads	Support for many Microsoft Advertising products, but not Performance Max or Audience ads
Additional Features	Supports incremental lift analyses to measure ad effectiveness	No support
	Supports view-through conversion attribution (for Audience ads bidding)	
	Supports auto conversions to easily detect your site events (in pilot)	

Set up Automated Bidding, Seasonality Adjustments, Attribution models

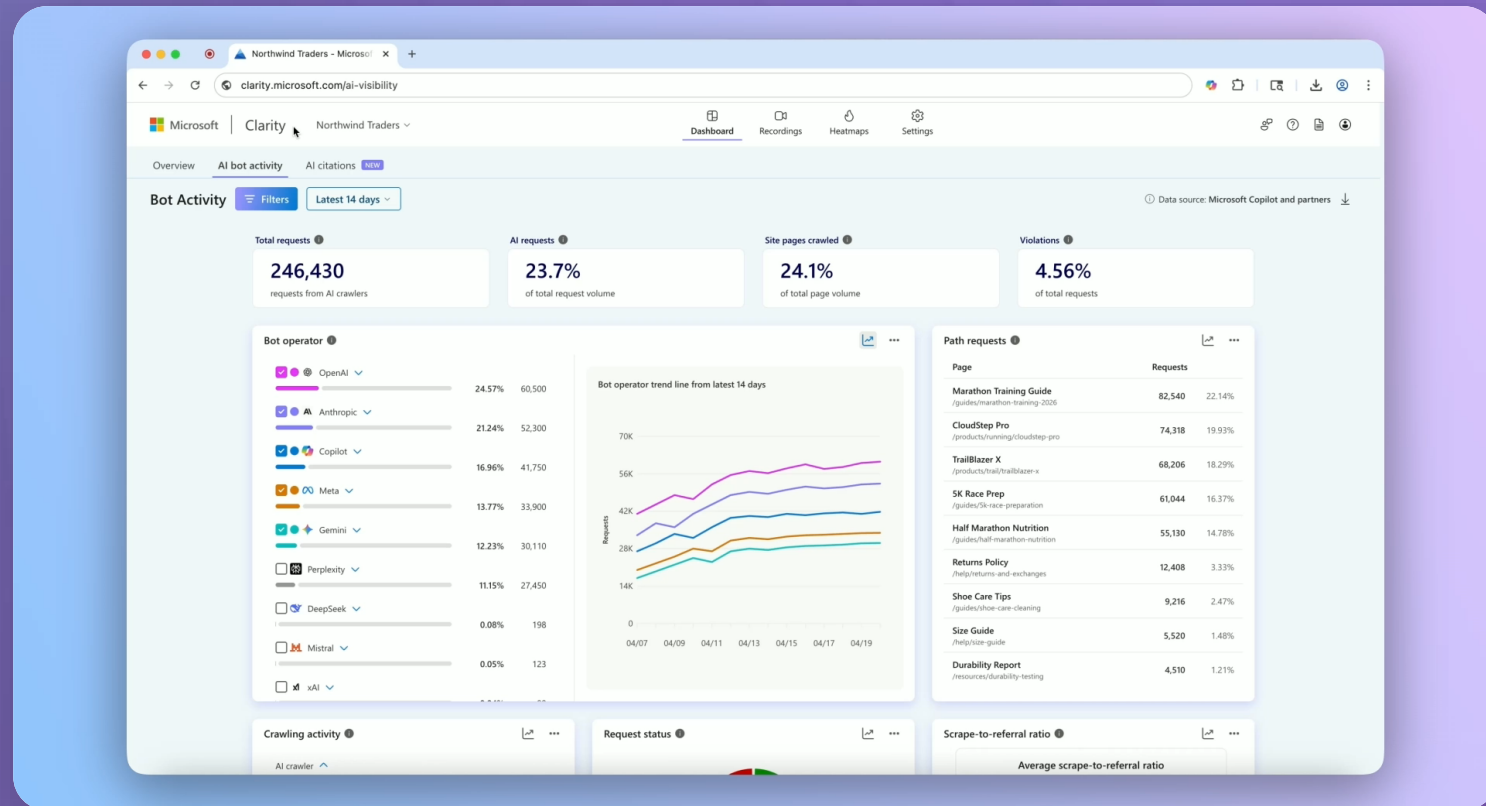


Microsoft Clarity

from AI discovery to on-site conversion

- **Get discovered in AI**
Clarity tracks how AI surfaces your brand
- **Know what to improve**
Clarity recommends how to lift visibility.
- **Win after the click**
Rage-clicks and drop-offs stay hidden.
Clarity reveals on-site behavior to optimize.

Setup Clarity
today



Validate your measurement foundation

Audit UET implementation monthly and after major site updates.

Incomplete or misfiring tags limit optimization.

Validate tracking end-to-end from click through conversion reporting.

- Copilot in MAP: Use a prompt like: ***Test my '[Conversion Goal Name]' goal and confirm if UET is configured correctly on my site.***
- Use **Test This Goal** feature on conversion goal grid



The screenshot displays the Microsoft Advertising interface for account 'Contoso (123456789)'. The left sidebar shows navigation options: Campaigns, Conversion goals (selected), Offline conversions, Customer acquisition, Ads Studio, Import, Reporting, Merchant Center, Billing, Settings, and Tools. The main content area is titled 'Conversion goals' and includes a search bar, a '+ New goal' button, and a table of existing goals.

Goal name	Tracking status	Included in "Conversions"	Type	Scope	Count	Conversion window
CONTOSO_Direct_Sale	Recording conversions	Yes	Event	On account: Contoso - G145CNBX	All	30 days, 0 hours, and 0 minutes
LEAD_Gen_Form	Tag inactive	Yes	Event	On account: Contoso - G145CNBX	All	30 days, 0 hours, and 0 minutes
LEAD_Demo_Booked	Recording conversions	Yes	Destination URL	On account: Contoso - G145CNBX	All	30 days, 0 hours, and 0 minutes
PreOrder_Submit	Recording conversions	Yes	Destination URL	On account: Contoso - G145CNBX	All	30 days, 0 hours, and 0 minutes
Transaction_Complete	No recent conversions	Yes	Event	On account: Contoso - G145CNBX	All	30 days, 0 hours, and 0 minutes
Pricing_View	Unverified	Yes	Event	On account: Contoso - G145CNBX	All	30 days, 0 hours, and 0 minutes
Outbound_Partner_Click	Recording conversions	Yes	Event	On account: Contoso - G145CNBX	All	30 days, 0 hours, and 0 minutes
REG_Account_Created	Recording conversions	Yes	Destination URL	On account: Contoso - G145CNBX	All	30 days, 0 hours, and 0 minutes

Rows per page: 25 < 1 of 31 >

Not all metrics are in real time. Clicks and Impressions in the last 1 hour, UET conversions in the last 2 hours, and Non-UET conversions (App Install, Offline Conversions) in the last 5 hours might not be included. [Learn more](#)
Only search ads clicks are MRC accredited; other metrics are not MRC accredited. [Learn more](#). The time zone for the date range is (GMT-05:00) Eastern Time (U.S. & Canada) [Learn more](#)

Steps to implement your PMax strategy

1

Prepare

- Select Goal
- Add Merchant center
- If importing, check that audience signals match
- Turn on Auto-Generated assets

2

Launch

- Add Assets & targeting
- Finalize details, start on Max Conversions/Revenue to reach 30 conversions faster
- Give 2-3x average campaign budget
- Impression-Based Remarketing will pull in all users who have been served CTV, Video Ads, Display Ads, Native Ads

3

Learning period

- Ensure no Budget caps
- Avoid major changes unless necessary
- Minimum 30 conversions before using tCPA

4

Evaluate

- Add Website exclusions at manager account level
- Negative keywords in shared library
- Tweak audience signals
- Exclude time-of-day
- Block auto-generated assets if needed
- Review Brand Exclusions

Wrap the basics — Holidays checklist

Before demand builds, confirm the campaign, feed, measurement, and bidding fundamentals are ready for AI-assisted discovery and peak-season scale.

Campaign mix & structure

- ☐ Confirm the right mix across Search, Shopping, AI Max, PMax, and Audience ads.
- ☐ Consolidate low-volume campaigns or use portfolio strategies where learning is thin.
- ☐ Reserve Exact Match for must-have terms; use Broad Match, AI Max, and PMax for expansion.

Feeds & AI readiness

- ☐ Upload 100% of the catalog and complete UCP / Merchant Center settings.
- ☐ Enrich titles and descriptions with variant details, seasonal use cases, and valid IDs.
- ☐ Tag hero products, best sellers, promotions, and strategic inventory with custom labels.

Measurement & bidding

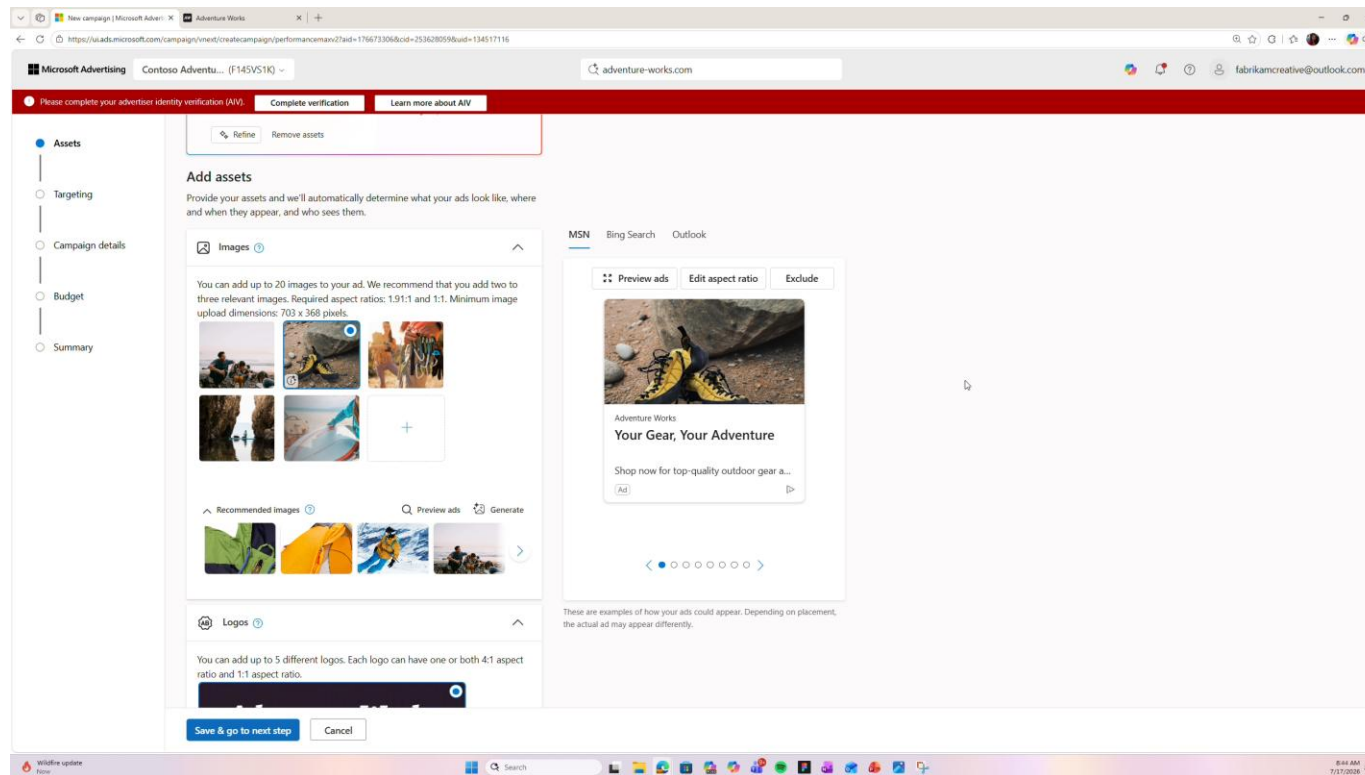
- ☐ Validate UET, conversion goals, attribution model, and conversion values end to end.
- ☐ Set up bidding experiments and seasonality adjustments early enough to learn.

Recent feature updates & coming soon



Ad preview hub

Now available for Audience ads and Performance Max



Preview before you publish

See exactly how your ads will appear across placements, formats, and devices so you can launch with confidence and avoid costly surprises.

Validate creative quality at scale

Quickly review headlines, descriptions, images, logos, and videos together to identify gaps, inconsistencies, or formatting issues before they impact performance.

Streamline collaboration and approvals

Give marketers, creatives, and stakeholders a single destination to review ad experiences, align on execution, and accelerate campaign launch timelines.

Landing page reporting

As of April 2026, landing page reporting by Final URL for PMax is now available

Landing pages Entire time: 4/2/2023 - 4/2/2026

[+ Add filter](#) Columns [Download](#)

Destination URL	Impr.	Final URL	Clicks	CTR	Avg. CPC	Spend	Conv.	Top impr. rate	Abs. top impr. rate
	4,724	https://www.contoso.com/travel	110	2.33%	0.67	73.30	0.00	0.06%	0.06%
	2,770	https://www.contoso.com/automotive	118	4.26%	0.97	114.38	2.00	57.18%	24.49%
	25,625	https://contoso.com/health	937	3.66%	1.18	1,103.35	89.00	32.95%	16.31%
	327	https://www.contoso.com/entertainment	31	9.48%	3.27	101.46	12.00	60.19%	44.83%

Landing pages

Modify columns

Search column

Level of detail

Performance

Conversions

Custom parameters

Tracking template

Final URL suffix

Ad group

Ad group ID

Campaign

Campaign ID

Add all columns

Add

Add

Add

Add

Add

Add

Selected columns (drag and drop to reorder)

Remove all selected columns

Final URL

Clicks

CTR

Avg. CPC

Spend

Conv.

Remove

Remove

Remove

Remove

Remove

Remove

☐ Save this set of columns

[Apply](#) [Cancel](#)

Landing pages

Modify columns

Search column

Level of detail

Performance

Conversions

Conv. rate

CPA

Return on ad spend

Revenue

All conv.

All conv. CPA

All conv. rate

Add all columns

Add

Add

Add

Add

Add

Add

You can add other columns to customize your view, from custom parameters to asset group name and ID, as well as conversion metrics like all conv. revenue and ROAS.

Performance metrics in the Website URL (publisher) report

Unlike Google Ads, Microsoft's Website URL (publisher) report for Performance Max now shows more performance metrics than just impressions

The screenshot displays the Microsoft Advertising interface for a 'Website URL (publisher)' report. The report shows data for 20 accounts, including 'Lamps Plus' and 'ecosia.org'. The table includes columns for Account, Website URL, Campaign type, Impressions, Clicks, CTR, Avg. CPC, Spend, Revenue, Video views, Conversions, CPA, Assists, Return on ad spend, All Revenue, and View-through conversions. The data is filtered for 'Performance max' campaigns and sorted by 'All Revenue' in descending order.

Account	Website URL	Campaign type	Impressions	Clicks	CTR	Avg. CPC	Spend	Revenue	Video views	Conversions	CPA	Assists	Return on ad spend	All Revenue	View-through conversions
Lamps Plus	microsoft sites and select traffic	Performance max	62,311	123	0.20%	1.22	169.97	2,331.00	0	2.00	95.49	0	12.00%	2,331.00	0
Lamps Plus	microsoft sites and select traffic	Performance max	36,077	107	0.30%	1.52	162.57	1,597.91	0	3.00	54.19	0	982.91%	1,600.91	0
Lamps Plus	microsoft sites and select traffic	Performance max	13,025	42	0.32%	0.55	22.94	114.90	0	2.00	11.47	0	500.87%	116.90	0
Lamps Plus	microsoft sites and select traffic	Performance max	30,317	123	0.41%	0.88	107.94	435.95	0	2.00	53.97	0	403.88%	438.95	0
Lamps Plus	microsoft sites and select traffic	Performance max	255,965	259	0.10%	0.79	203.32	819.92	0	1.00	203.32	0	403.27%	820.92	0
Lamps Plus	microsoft sites and select traffic	Performance max	141,801	426	0.30%	2.75	1,169.64	3,970.93	0	7.00	167.09	0	339.50%	3,982.93	0
Lamps Plus	microsoft sites and select traffic	Performance max	6,896	44	0.64%	1.90	83.55	239.72	0	1.00	83.55	0	286.92%	240.72	0
Lamps Plus	microsoft sites and select traffic	Performance max	6,268	67	1.07%	1.44	96.22	199.99	0	1.00	96.22	0	207.85%	200.99	0
Lamps Plus	microsoft sites and select traffic	Performance max	2,967	53	1.79%	0.84	44.64	69.00	0	1.00	44.64	0	154.57%	70.00	0
Lamps Plus	microsoft sites and select traffic	Performance max	51,930	94	0.18%	2.15	202.18	239.99	0	1.00	202.18	0	128.59%	261.99	0
Lamps Plus	ecosia.org	Performance max	231	2	0.87%	0.12	0.23	0.00	0	0.00		0	0.00%	0.00	0
Lamps Plus	www.duckduckgo.com	Performance max	8,256	29	0.35%	0.55	16.08	0.00	0	0.00		0	0.00%	0.00	0
Lamps Plus	aol search properties only	Performance max	41	1	2.44%	1.13	1.13	0.00	0	0.00		0	0.00%	0.00	0
Lamps Plus	12thmanising.com	Performance max	3	1	33.33%	2.97	2.97	0.00	0	0.00		0	0.00%	0.00	0
Lamps Plus	besthealthexpert.com	Performance max	1	1	100.00%	0.53	0.53	0.00	0	0.00		0	0.00%	0.00	0
Lamps Plus	bestlifeonline.com	Performance max	12	2	16.67%	0.56	1.11	0.00	0	0.00		0	0.00%	0.00	0
Lamps Plus	microsoft sites and select traffic	Performance max	4,171	8	0.19%	0.84	6.74	0.00	0	0.00		0	0.00%	0.00	0
Lamps Plus	microsoft sites and select traffic	Performance max	1,244	2	0.16%	0.24	0.47	0.00	0	0.00		0	0.00%	0.00	0
Lamps Plus	microsoft sites and select traffic	Performance max	104	1	0.96%	0.05	0.05	0.00	0	0.00		0	0.00%	0.00	0
Lamps Plus	microsoft sites and select traffic	Performance max	3,655	4	0.11%	1.98	7.93	0.00	0	0.00		0	0.00%	0.00	0

Data available as of April 22, 2026

Website URL (publisher) report (aka placement reporting)

Performance Max capabilities vs Google Ads



Performance Max capabilities	Google Ads	Microsoft Advertising
Serving on chat ads	In beta	Serving text-based and image-based ads on Copilot
Campaign limit	100 campaigns	Up to 300 campaigns
Video assets	Available	Not available for Performance Max
Multimedia ads	N/A	Available for Performance Max and other campaign types
Search themes (up to 50)	Available	Available for Performance Max (note: additional search themes don't limit volume on Microsoft Advertising)
LinkedIn profile targeting and LinkedIn powered in-market audiences as audience signals	N/A	Available for Performance Max in select markets
Impression-based remarketing	N/A	Available for Performance Max and other campaign types
Conversion value rules	Available	
Disclaimer support	N/A	
Asset group level reporting	Available	Available
Budget suggestions for new campaigns	Available	Available
Share of voice metrics for PMax	Available	Available
Asset group URL options and tracking templates	Available	Available
New customer acquisition goal (purchase goals)	Available	Available
Self-serve negative keyword support for PMax	Available	Available
Landing page + auction insights reporting	Available	Coming Soon
Experiments and incrementality testing support	Available	Coming Soon
Age and gender targeting	Available	Coming Soon
Ad preview hub for PMax	Available	Coming Soon
Channel performance reporting	Available	Coming Soon
Support for vertical ads	Available	Coming Soon

Audience generation

Turn your audience ideas into actionable targeting, instantly

Closed PILOT

New

The screenshot shows the Microsoft Advertising interface for an audience campaign. The left sidebar has a navigation menu with 'Ads' selected. The main area is titled 'Ad group, audiences, & targets' and includes a text input for 'Ad group name' (containing 'Contoso Tech 2026') and a 'Generate' button. Below this is a 'Targeting' section with a text input for 'Who's your target audience?' and a 'Generate' button. The right sidebar shows 'Estimates' for 'Weekly' targeting, displaying a reach of 386.51M users using MSN, Outlook, and Casual Games. At the bottom, there are buttons for 'Back', 'Save & go to next step', and 'Save and exit'.

Create audiences using natural language

Describe who you want to reach in plain language. Audience generation translates that intent into ready-to-use audience targeting, without manual setup.

Reach the right customers with more precision

Go beyond static, predefined segments. Audience generation helps capture nuance and intent by creating tailored AI audiences alongside familiar targeting controls, helping you avoid overly broad targeting.

Stay in control with transparent recommendations

AI suggests audiences, but you decide what to use. Review recommended targeting, and confidently activate what works best for your campaign goals.

Term exclusions & Messaging constraints

Generate brand and legally compliant ad copy at scale

A

Text guidelines

Campaign wide

Term exclusions

None added.

Messaging constraints

None added.

Edit text guidelines

B

Asset optimization

Combine your assets with AI-generated ones to maximize your ad performance.

☒ Text customization

Use text from your website, landing pages, ads, and provided assets to create customized ad copy.

Edit text guidelines

Text guidelines

Term exclusions

Enter words or phrases that shouldn't appear in your ads.

Cheap
Low cost
Value

25 exclusions remaining

Messaging constraints

Add any rules for how messages should or shouldn't be written, such as tone, style, themes, or required language. You can add up to 40 constraints.

Never imply that our products are low cost or a bargain

127 characters remaining

Capitalize every word in a headline

158 characters remaining

Don't use language that emphasizes discounts, deals, or immediate calls to action

106 characters remaining

Term exclusions are exact terms you want to block from ad copy. Add up to 25.

Messaging constraints are a broader set of messaging and formatting guardrails for ad copy. Add up to 40.

Brand and legal compliance at scale

Block specific words and phrases that should never appear in ad copy and set broader messaging guardrails.

More control over what AI says and how it says it

Dictate formatting and messaging rules that steer AI-generated copy toward their desired voice and emphasis.

Faster creative production

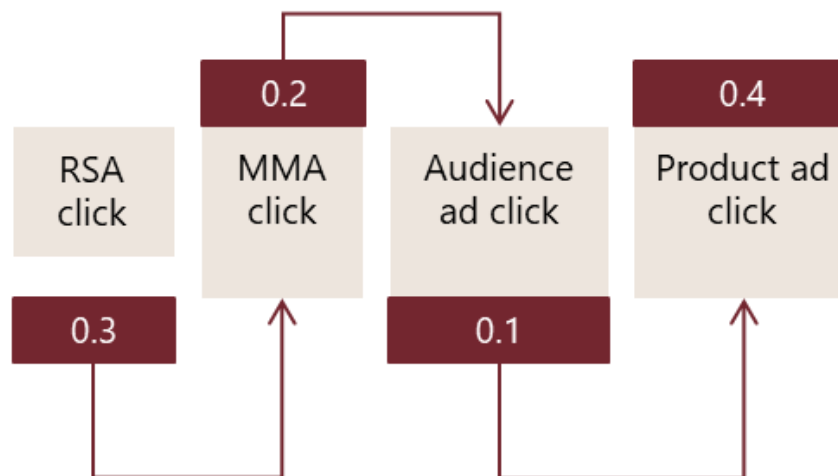
Spend less time rewriting and policing drafts, and more time launching/testing variants.

Data-driven attribution model

Closed PILOT**New**

Give credit across multiple ad touchpoints, rather than assigning full credit to the last click

Example of conversion credit distribution via DDA



DDA output: Conversion credit attributed to all relevant user touchpoints

Smarter Autobidding Optimization
Gives autobidding a richer conversion data to make better bid decisions across campaigns.

Full-Funnel Conversion Credit
Gives credit to more of the ads that helped drive the conversion, from awareness to the conversion, not just the final click.

Account-Specific
Uses the advertiser's own conversion data to understand what's influencing results in that campaign, making it more tailored to that advertiser.

Objection handling



Performance Max objection handling

“

I am worried
Performance Max
will cannibalize my
search campaigns.

”

“

Performance
Max will drive
up my CPCs so
I won't try it.

”

“

I don't need to
have Performance
Max and Audience
ads together.

”

“

I'm already live
in both Audience
ads and search,
why do I need
PMax?

”

Top takeaways

If you remember just a few things from today's session, make it these:

Top takeaways

1. PMax continues to provide differentiated value for customers with our **unique network/focus on lower-funnel**, unique entities like **MMA** and the **tone tool in Copilot**, and unique signals in **LinkedIn** and **Impression-based remarketing**. We've also made import a bit easier, but you may find it better/faster to build from scratch.
2. Structure PMax around **business dimensions** (products, brands, audiences) while **staying consolidated** to let AI optimize—paired with **compelling creative** that reflects real ad experiences.
3. Respect **Learning period**, ensure you **have the right budget and bid strategy** (do not change too quickly and too often), include all relevant formats. Refresh assets often.
4. Impression-based remarketing can open a lot of doors for PMax success and testing Audience ads, especially for non-UET customers. Try setting up a **small 'always-on' Audience ad campaign to fuel your impression-based remarketing list** and add it as a signal to your PMax campaign to help connect the dots.
5. **View objections as opportunities**. By understanding the reasons behind objections, leveraging effective strategies, you can foster trust, demonstrate value, and ultimately achieve success. Every objection is a chance to engage the client on a deeper level and reinforce the merits of Performance Max.

PMax checklist for Campaign success

Steps to implement and optimize your Performance Max Campaign

Preparation phase

- ☐ Ensure Universal Event Tracking (UET) is set up across your website*
 - **If using offline conversions, UET is not required (but still encouraged). Please ensure you are uploading offline conversions frequently*
- ☐ Verify that conversion tracking is accurately implemented.
- ☐ Review budget allocation for PMax campaigns.
- ☐ Set realistic campaign goals (e.g., Max Conversions or Max Conversion Value). *Recommended to implement Maximize Conversions or Max Conversion Value until 30 conversions in 30 days are met.*

Campaign setup within Microsoft's Advertising Platform (MAP)

- ☐ Select your campaign goal (e.g., Drive Conversions or Sell Products).
- ☐ Choose Performance Max as your campaign type.
- ☐ For retail campaigns, associate with a Merchant Center store and ensure the feed is active.
- ☐ Input creative assets, including high-quality images and text, relevant to your brand.
 - If running solely PMax Shopping, assets are not required.
- ☐ Use audience signals like Remarketing, Customer Match, and LinkedIn profile targeting.
- ☐ Enable Final URL Expansion to allow dynamic landing page optimization.

Optimization phase

- ☐ Respect the learning period (2–4 weeks) and avoid major changes during this time.
- ☐ Only introduce Target CPA/ROAS after reaching 30+ conversions in 30 days.
- ☐ Leverage search themes to provide signals and enhance campaign targeting efficiency.
- ☐ Adjust budgets incrementally (10–20%) every 10–14 days after the learning period.
- ☐ Monitor campaign performance for high CPCs.
- ☐ Consolidate campaigns where possible. Microsoft PMAx performs better with fewer, data-rich campaigns.
- ☐ Update assets periodically to prevent user fatigue and optimize performance.

PMax checklist for Campaign success (cont.)

Steps to implement and optimize your Performance Max Campaign

Troubleshooting

- ☐ If experiencing budget exhaustion, ensure no budget caps and consider adding CPA or ROAS targets.
- ☐ Refresh asset imagery and ensure auto-generated assets are enabled.
- ☐ If volume drops, review audience signals and campaign goals for alignment.
- ☐ Check conversion tracking, if conversions are not tracking the bid strategy cannot adjust.

Advanced strategies

- ☐ Incorporate Impression-Based Remarketing to reconnect with users exposed to display, video, and native ads.
- ☐ Use URL rules at the asset group level to refine landing page targeting for specific queries.
- ☐ Apply brand exclusions list (in the form of website URLs) to focus on generic terms and exclude unwanted branded traffic. This can also exclude competitor brand searches as well.

Evaluation and reporting

- ☐ Track audience insights reporting for detailed metrics at the campaign and asset level.
- ☐ Use the Search Term Insights Report and the Publisher URL report to refine exclusions and targeting strategies.
- ☐ Monitor delivery status and utilize the Budget Landscape tool for recommended adjustments.

Thank you



Survey

We want to hear your thoughts!